Islamic ethics and AI



JUNAID QADIR

Lorentz center
Workshop @Snellius

The Future of Muslim Tech

Prospects and Challenges

16 - 20 January 2023, Leiden, the Netherlands

Reviewing Modern AI Critically

Looking at technology critically

AI-Driven Social Media



Making Sense of the World
Misinformation, conspiracy theories, and fake news

Politics and Elections
Propaganda, distorted dialogue & a disrupted democratic process

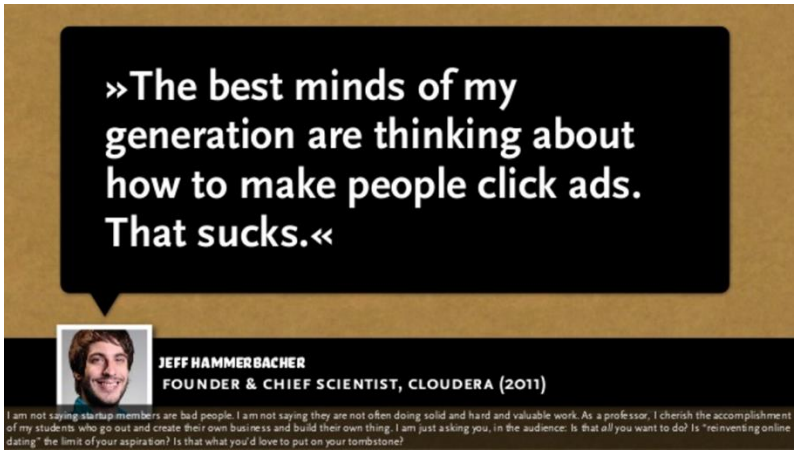
Social Relationships
Less empathy, more confusion and misinterpretation

Physical and Mental Health
Stress, loneliness, feelings of addiction, and increased risky health behavior



"Every new technology will bite back. The more powerful its gifts, the more powerfully it can be abused."

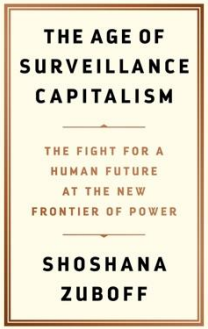
The problems of privacy and surveillance











(Can I trust the prediction of an AI model?)

Bias (Can the ML model learn our biases?)

Privacy (Is the ML model protecting our privacy?)

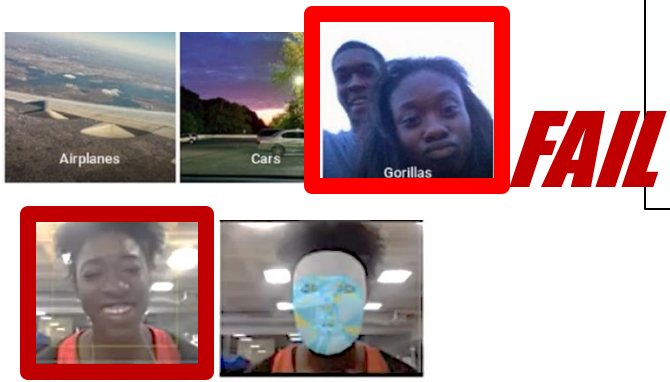
Interpretability (Can we understand ML models' "reasoning"?)

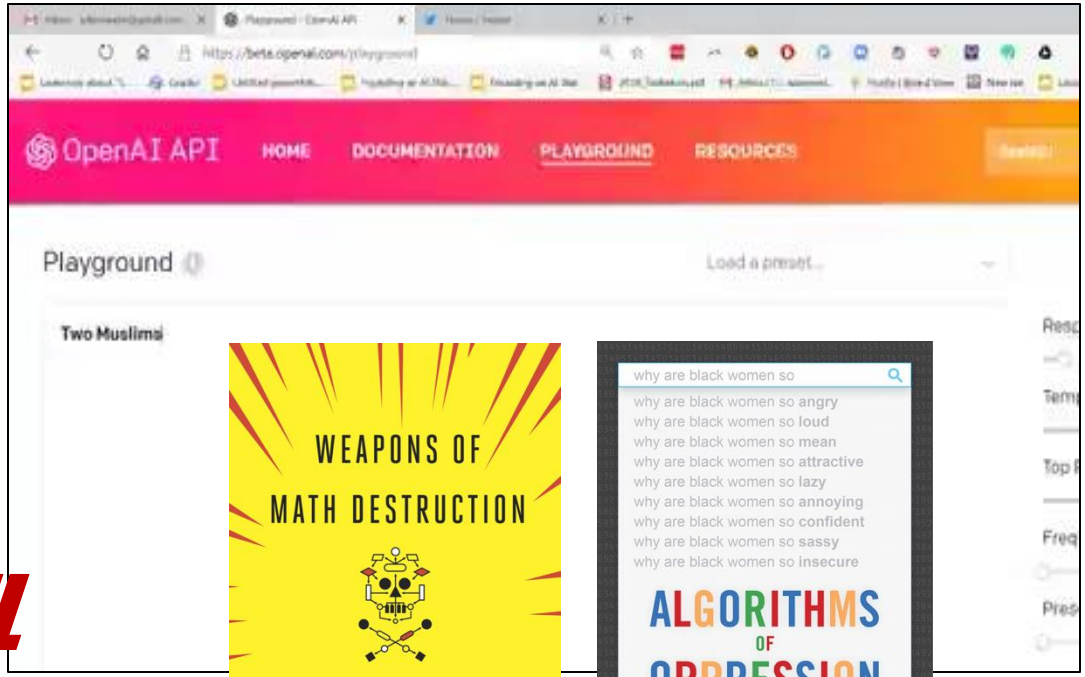
Robustness (Is the ML model robust against adversarial attacks?)

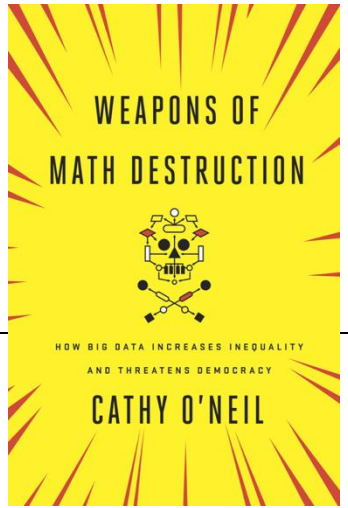
The potential of bias with AI

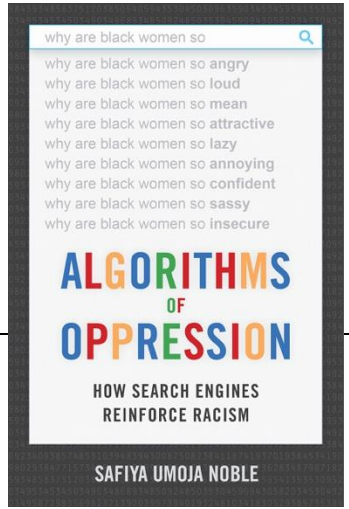


Generative Pre-trained Transformer 3 ***(GPT-3)*** *is the AI-based generative language model created by* ***OpenAI****. ChatGPT is a based on an extended version of GPT-3*









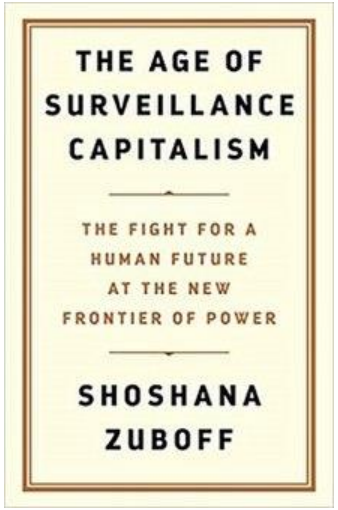
Towards Ethical and Trustworthy AI

Technology Is Driving the Future, But Who Is Steering?

1) *How is the technology that I am working on going to be used?*
2) *Who will benefit or suffer from it?*
3) *How much, and what social impact, will it have?*

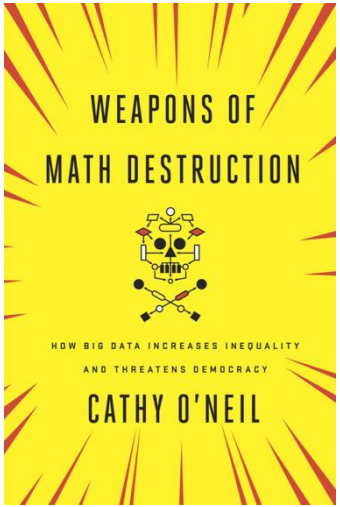
What happens when we ignore wisdom

SCIENCE BECOMES A TOOL FOR POWER AND MANIPULATION



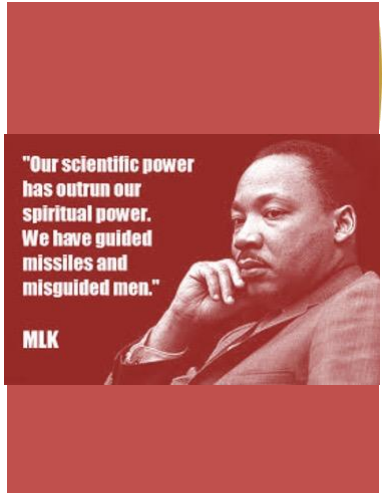
IATROGENICS

The Wounds that the Healer Gave



KING MIDAS EFFECT

The importance of objective and purpose



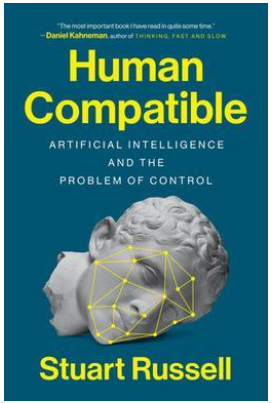


Value Alignment Problem

You implicitly agree that you don't care at all about everything you don't explicitly specify

Suppose we give AI the tasks of curing cancer asap





The rise of AI Ethics



nature machine intelligence

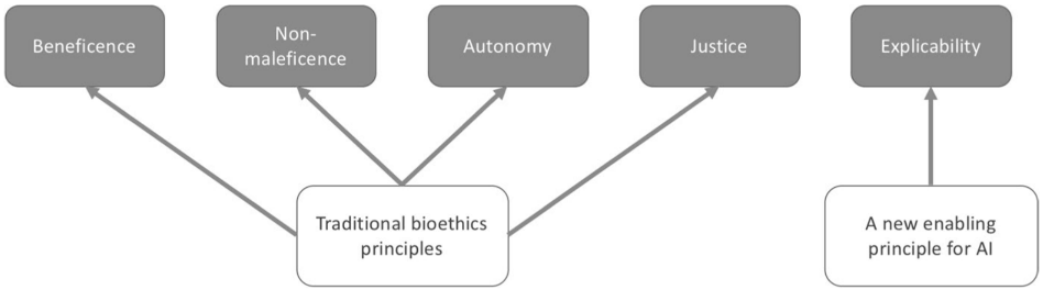
PERSPECTIVE

https://doi.org/10.1038/s42256-019-0088-2

The global landscape of AI ethics guidelines

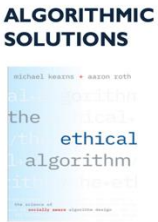
Anna Jobin, Marcello Ienca and Effy Vayena*

Four higher-level ethical principles—**beneficence, non-maleficence, justice, and autonomy**—capture the essence of most AI declarations



We need not only ethics but also appropriate regulation, laws, public policies, and strong national and international institutions





Why consider Islamic Ethics for AI?

Discover Artificial Intelligence

Discover

Perspective

Islamic virtue-based ethics for artificial intelligence

Amana Raquib[1] · Bilal Channa[1] · Talat Zubair[2] · Junaid Qadir[3]

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Limitations of Current Approaches

nature machine intelligence

PERSPECTIVE

https://doi.org/10.1038/s42256-019-0114-4

Principles alone cannot guarantee ethical AI

Corporations and influential stakeholders usually resort to utilitarian explanations to justify whatever actions are in their individual vested interests.

Current AI ethics approaches suffer from:

1) *based on **principalism;***
2) ***non-holism** (limited coordination between users, designers, deployers, policymakers, national and international governance)*
3) *a **lack of diversity***

*Another major deficiency is: indifference and lack of attention to **Islamic objectives (maqāsid) or any spiritual goals;***

Seeking public good and welfare with AI

We need to have a universal outlook that looks for the benefit of the human collective (at the level of a family, professional guild, nation, and at international level) and aims to establish justice and beneficial civilizational supports (irtafaqāt)

الرَّأْي الجزئي

al-rāʾy al-juzʾī: *Opinion based on individual purposes*

الرَّأْي الكُلّي

***al-rāʾy al-kulli*:** Opinion based on universality of purpose



realigning technology with humanity's best interests.

This requires multidisciplinary collaboration between people from the fields of technology, public policy, ethics, politics, and Islamic philosophy.

An Islamic Perspective

Allah created humans, the world, the universe for a purpose (maqsad)



Human beings desire various objectives —
but they are not all on the same level.



The objectives at the level of essentials (necessity) [darurāt] are most important

Islamic Perspective on Humans, World, Life

Economic/material progress is not the only kind of progress that is sought.
Success comes from perfection of character and purification of the heart and soul.

Following desires is not sought per se – desires are to be curtailed and regulated.
One who follows his desires blindly without guidance from God is astray.

Human beings have two potentialities—*(1) angelic; and (2) animalistic.*
A system is good for human progress /benefit only if simultaneously satisfies both these needs.

This world is real but transitory. There is an afterlife that is more permanent and real.
Islamic yardstick of success is different (Real success is the success of the afterlife.)



International Conference on Islamic Ethics and AI

20th & 21st, Dec, 2021

Nishat, Gulberg, Lahore

www.islamicaiethics.info

Ethics in Artificial Intelligence (AI) Research Initiative for the Asia Pacific

IEEE ITU, Punjab Student Society | ITU | IBA | AL-QADIR | NAFEEHA INSTITUTE

18	2	15
Talks	Days	Speakers

Islamic AI Ethics Lahore Declaration (Dec. 2021)

1. **AI has the potential for use that greatly benefits humanity and also potential for great harm.**
2. **AI technology acts as an amplifying force.** AI can be used for doing social good or social evil much more forcefully than what is possible without AI.
3. **Problems wrought by technology will not be solved by technology alone.** Ultimately people and their habits and mindset have to be transformed according to the higher values sought for the society.
4. **Benefits and harms**, according to the Islamic perspective, include, but are **not limited to, material and worldly concerns**.
5. In an Islamic worldview, the **human interests of religion, life, intellect, wealth, lineage, and dignity demand systemic preservation and protection through ethics, policies, and law.**
6. When venturing into new domains where there is potential for benefit and harm, **warding off harm has priority over gaining potential benefits, and harms and/or benefits known with certainty or high probability are prioritized over posited benefits or harms**.

Islamic AI Ethics Lahore Declaration (Dec. 2021)

7. **AI should not be used to promote or aid injustice** (*ẓūlm*) in any of its forms.
8. **AI should not be considered parochially with a narrow focus on the vested self-interests** of individual person/ corporation/ country.
9. **Big tech corporations**, many of which have global users that outnumber large nations, are managed according to their own commercial interests. ***There must be national and international mechanisms, institutions, and agreements, that help ensure that technology is used in a way that benefits all of humanity.***
10. **Ethical use of AI cannot be realized just through principles.** An entire system of complementary subsystems (moral, ethical, educational, economic, legal) promoting human-beneficial AI is needed.
11. **Effects of AI should be studied holistically with a universal outlook (*ray al-kulli*) focusing on individuals, communities, and the environment.** The focus on the universal outlook can provide a common ethical platform that allows alignment with other religious and ethical philosophies that emphasize human good and well-being.
12. **There is a need for a system that thinks for all humanity.** *Islam can provide this inclusive system that caters to and promotes the welfare of all humanity.*

Thank you

jqadir@qu.edu.qa